

Armed conflict

CONFLICT / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

If fighting or explosions are nearby, move away from windows and exposed areas into the most protective intact space you can reach safely. Keep family members together, shoes and essential medicines close, and a plan for losing phone service. Do not cross active fighting for supplies or touch suspicious debris. Assistance and safe passage may be unavailable; judge movement against the danger of staying.

Do now.

- ☐ **Choose shelter before the next attack**
01 Prefer a designated protective shelter if safely reachable. Otherwise use the most protective intact interior area available, away from glazing. Consider collapse, fire and flooding as well as blast exposure; no ordinary room guarantees safety.
- ☐ **Keep essentials beside you**
02 Gather a battery light, footwear, safe water, medicines and written contacts without exposing yourself to retrieve them. Keep corridors and exits clear.
- ☐ **Make a family check-in plan**
03 Choose nearby and out-of-area reunion contacts. Use short private messages with your location and status; do not publish live movements or other people's locations.
- ☐ **Reassess before moving**
04 Confirm a destination and route as recently as possible with independent trusted information. A claimed corridor or ceasefire is not proof of safe passage. Do not cross active fighting.
- ☐ **Avoid explosive debris**
05 Leave unfamiliar objects, wires, fragments and abandoned munitions untouched. Warn people from a safe position and use verified demining or humanitarian channels when safe.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Choose the most protective reachable room before another attack, keep footwear and a light there, and keep essential medicines close. Do not cross active fighting to collect supplies. Use verified humanitarian contacts and trusted people; government assistance or safe passage may not exist.

Watch for.

A lull is not an all-clear. Fire, damaged structures, unexploded ordnance and interrupted utilities remain dangerous. Avoid confrontation with armed personnel; local protection risks determine whether contacting officials is safe.

People & practical needs.

Choose two reunion places and an out-of-area contact. Keep children with a trusted caregiver and carry a written contact card

Next decision.

Inventory water, food, medical supplies and power for the people with you. Arrange care tasks and check-ins with trusted neighbours where safe. Verify humanitarian assistance directly; do not assume government, embassy or aid transport will arrive.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

ICRC · Explosive remnants of war

U.S. State Department · Crisis response

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/armed-conflict/>